USER HANDBOOK / OCTOBER 2026

Market Lens

How it works.
How to read the rules.

A practical guide to the Windows app and hosted dashboard: market screening, broader direction, selected-coin confirmation and data-quality messages.

Read evidence in this order
Data readiness → Overall Direction → Coin checks → Conditional plan → Your review. A score such as 6/6 is rule agreement, not a measured win probability.

A five-step first session

- **1. Open the app.** Use the Market Lens Local shortcut or the live website. In the local app, check This PC if the collector appears stopped.
- **2. Click Refresh.** Loading means the request is still running. Read the final success, partial or failure message after results render.
- **3. Check Overall Direction.** Read 1h direction and 15m confirmation. Add 4h alignment only when you want that extra requirement.
- **4. Review a coin.** Use All Markets or your Watchlist. In Trade Confirmation, search, select the coin, then click Analyse it.
- **5. Read the reasons and expiry.** Review the source, entry, stop, targets and costs. The app does not send orders or monitor an exchange position.

Find what you need

Topic	Page	Topic	Page
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Six screener checks	3	Stops, targets and costs	7
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OI and CVD explained	5	Local data / fillable checklist	9 / 10

Edition scope: current local/source rules, GitHub commit e149eb6 and hosted release 28. The existing Windows v0.3.0 installer predates these source improvements; an older installation may differ.

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Use each workspace deliberately

The screen is a saved observation. Refresh requests new information; navigation does not start a new market scan.

Workspace	Action	What to read
All Markets	Choose 15m or 1h; click Refresh.	Exchange label, scan coverage, six checks and the age of each result. Search, filters, sorting and pagination work on loaded data.
Watchlist	Star a coin; open Watchlist.	Your selected coins. The screener's **Watch** filter means incomplete setups and is different from your personal Watchlist.
Overall Direction	Click Refresh; choose a horizon to inspect.	1h direction, 15m confirmation and optional 4h alignment. Supporting BTC, OI and spot-flow panels have their own readiness.
Trade Confirmation	Search → select → Analyse it.	Only the selected OKX coin is analysed, with BTC and market context. Auto, Long and Short choose which case to evaluate.
Data health / This PC	Open the relevant diagnostics.	Provider errors and timestamps; local collector, storage and backup status. This PC belongs to the Windows app.

Manual display, separate background work

- **Refresh / Analyse it:** request an update. One click can run several paced batches, so a full scan or first OI recovery can take minutes.
- **Switching sections:** preserves the displayed snapshot and settings. Sorting or changing a view does not make old data current.
- **Time passing:** age and expiry labels can change without fetching new data. An old setup can become stale while prices on screen remain unchanged.
- **Windows collector:** keeps collecting when Brave is closed, provided the service is running and the PC is awake and online. It does not push a refresh into the open screen.

Success is about the request. “Refresh succeeded” means the requested results were rendered successfully. “3/4 feeds updated” means one feed remains pending or failed; it does not mean 75% signal accuracy.

Local watchlists are saved in the local database and shared across browsers on that installation. Hosted watchlists are browser-local; they do not automatically sync with the Windows app.

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All Markets: the six checks

The current screener uses EMA20 and four closed candles. Earlier experimental strategies such as Supertrend are not the rules of this screener.

The proposed side comes from the four-candle price move: positive or zero selects the long case; negative selects short. All six checks must pass for a full setup.

Check	LONG requirement	SHORT requirement
1. Price & trend	Move ≥ +0.15%; last close above EMA20.	Move ≤ -0.15%; last close below EMA20.
2. Open interest	Contract-unit OI change ≥ +0.25%.	Same: contract-unit OI change ≥ +0.25%.
3. Taker flow / CVD	Net futures taker imbalance ≥ +3%.	Net futures taker imbalance ≤ -3%.
4. Funding	8h-normalized rate ≤ +0.03%.	8h-normalized rate ≥ -0.03%.
5. USDT dominance	Comparable ~1h change ≤ -0.015 pp.	Comparable ~1h change ≥ +0.015 pp.
6. BTC dominance	Altcoins: change ≤ +0.10 pp. BTC itself: change ≥ 0 pp.	Altcoins: change ≥ -0.10 pp. BTC itself: change ≤ 0 pp.

Understand the labels

- **Long setup / Short setup:** all six checks pass using current data.
- **Long watch / Short watch:** the first four derivatives checks pass, but one or both dominance checks do not. Watch is a research candidate, not full confirmation.
- **Neutral:** at least one of the first four checks fails. **Stale:** the saved analysis or its inputs are too old or invalid. **Waiting:** no analysis is available yet.

The timeframe changes the measured window. On 15m, four candles cover 1 hour. On 1h, four candles cover 4 hours. Price, contract OI and taker flow use matching boundaries. The dominance comparison remains approximately 1 hour.

Freshness: saved analyses expire after 10 minutes or earlier if their source window fails validation. Dominance must be fresh within 30 minutes, with a same-provider baseline 55-75 minutes earlier. "pp" means percentage points: 6.50% to 6.52% is +0.02 pp.

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Overall Direction: broad alignment

This model uses a market-cap basket, breadth, BTC price and USDT basket-share change. It does not use the same six gates as All Markets.

Condition	15 minutes	1 hour	4 hours
LONG: alt basket return	≥ +0.08%	≥ +0.15%	≥ +0.30%
LONG: advancing coins	≥ 60%	≥ 60%	≥ 60%
LONG: USDT share	≤ -0.005 pp	≤ -0.005 pp	≤ -0.010 pp
LONG: BTC return	≥ -0.10%	≥ -0.10%	≥ -0.30%
SHORT: alt basket return	≤ -0.08%	≤ -0.15%	≤ -0.30%
SHORT: declining coins	≥ 60%	≥ 60%	≥ 60%
SHORT: USDT share	≥ +0.005 pp	≥ +0.005 pp	≥ +0.010 pp
SHORT: BTC return	≤ +0.10%	≤ +0.10%	≤ +0.30%

Every condition for a side must pass. A coin is advancing above +0.05%, declining below -0.05%, and flat within that band. Flat coins remain in the breadth denominator.

How the combined direction is chosen

- **Default:** 1h and 15m must agree for LONG BIAS or SHORT BIAS. Valid but mixed readings produce WAIT.
- **Require 4h alignment:** adds agreement from a usable 4h reading. Missing 4h history produces a collecting state; a conflicting 4h reading prevents alignment.
- **BTC share:** contributes relative-strength commentary. Its change must be available, but it is not a separate directional threshold in the table above.

Data comes before direction. Each horizon needs at least 50 altcoin returns, 90% breadth coverage and 90% relevant cap coverage, plus the provider's freshness/alignment checks. Missing history is shown as collecting or unavailable, not a neutral market conclusion.

The top-125 basket excludes BTC, ETH and known stablecoins for the main altcoin return. Current constituents and supply are held fixed for the return estimate. These basket shares are not the global dominance cards or TradingView's licensed TOTAL3ES, BTC.D or USDT.D indices.

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Separate the three kinds of history

Price history, dominance history and open-interest history solve different questions. Repairing one does not create the others.

Series	How to interpret it
15m direction	Compares measured CoinLore prices for the same coins, 13.5-16.5 minutes apart. Provider timestamps determine the interval; repeated clicks cannot manufacture an older price.
1h / 4h direction	1h uses provider returns. The local app can obtain separate CMC 4h context when the configured key and historical endpoint work. Otherwise collected same-provider history is needed. CMC 4h context is reused for about an hour and expires after 75 minutes.
Global dominance	The screener needs a comparable same-provider ~1h baseline. Optional CMC history can help where API access succeeds. Its availability does not guarantee a CoinLore 15m baseline.
Aggregate OI	Official OKX 5m history can supply 15m, 1h and 4h comparisons without waiting four new hours. Historical downloads still take time and may be rate-limited.

Crypto-only aggregate OI

- Eligible instruments are active, exchange-classified crypto, linear USDT perpetual futures on OKX. Non-crypto contracts, unknown categories, inverse contracts and delivery futures are excluded.
- Both comparison endpoints sum the same matched contracts. A comparison needs at least 50 contracts, 90% of current contract count and 90% of current USD OI. Recovery continues toward 100%.
- The panel shows matched count, USD coverage, actual duration, timestamps and pending reasons. Counts vary with the exchange listing universe. The 21 October hosted check reached 287/287 and excluded 212 non-crypto instruments; these are dated results, not fixed targets.

Two OI measures: the screener and selected-coin confirmation use contract-unit changes. Aggregate OI uses USD notional, so price changes affect its total. Increasing OI alone does not identify whether new longs or shorts dominate.

Keep CVD sources distinct

All Markets uses **futures** taker flow. Trade Confirmation uses **spot** buy-minus-sell flow over three aligned 5m buckets. Overall Direction's supporting spot-flow panel is a small sample, not market-wide CVD. Partial coverage remains partial.

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Trade Confirmation: seven checks

Search an active OKX USDT perpetual, select it, choose Auto / Long / Short, then click Analyse it. No analysis runs merely from typing or selecting.

Evidence	Rule used by the app
1. Overall direction	Fresh 1h altcoin basket bias must match the proposed side. This is basket-proxy confirmation, not TOTAL3ES swing structure.
2. BTC direction	For long, BTC's last closed 15m return must be ≥ -0.10% and last closed 1h return ≥ -0.15%. For short, returns must be ≤ +0.10% and ≤ +0.15%.
3. Break & retest	A closed 15m candle breaks the prior 20-bar range. A separate candle retests within 6 bars, closes back on the setup side and has a body in that direction.
4. Spot CVD change	Three closed 5m spot buckets must match the coin candle. Net imbalance ≥ +3% for long; ≤ -3% for short. Missing spot data is not replaced by futures flow.
5. Relative volume	Break-candle quote volume / prior 20-bar mean must be ≥ 1.20x. Without a break, the latest closed candle is shown only as context.
6. OI participation	Contract OI must grow ≥ +0.10% over either the matched 15m or 1h window, while the coin's four-candle price return moves in the setup direction.
7. Strength vs BTC	The coin's 1h return minus BTC's matching return must be ≥ +0.10 pp for long or ≤ -0.10 pp for short. BTC itself has this check marked not applicable.

A score alone is not enough

All applicable checks, a valid candidate plan and fresh funding/quotes are required. The spread must be ≤ 0.15% and estimated 24h perpetual turnover ≥ $1 million. The 8h-normalized funding rate must be ≤ +0.10% for long or ≥ -0.10% for short.

Closed bars confirm; a forming bar can invalidate. A retest can touch within 0.20 ATR of the broken level. A close more than 0.25 ATR back against the level invalidates the pattern. A completed retest has a 15-minute entry window.

The ATR reference here is the mean of 14 true ranges from prior candles. Auto evaluates both directions; forcing Long or Short changes the case reviewed, not the underlying evidence. WAIT means requirements are unmet; DATA UNAVAILABLE means required inputs are missing.

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Read the conditional trade plan

A plan is a reference from the last analysis. It is not an exchange order, a fill confirmation or continuous position management.

Field	Meaning
Entry	The confirmed retest candle close. This historical reference may differ from the current executable price.
Stop-loss	Long: lowest low from break through retest, minus 0.25 ATR. Short: highest high over that region, plus 0.25 ATR.
Target 1 / Target 2	1R / 2R from the reference entry, where R is the absolute entry-to-stop distance. These levels are before costs; the app does not execute partial exits.
Net reward/risk	Estimated reward to Target 2 after costs, divided by the stop loss plus costs. Model assumption: 0.05% taker fee + 0.02% slippage on each fill's notional. Funding is not included in this calculation.
Validity	At most 15 minutes after retest confirmation for the plan. The displayed analysis can expire sooner, normally within 90 seconds or earlier when an input expires.

Why a plan becomes retired or is withheld

- The stop or first target has already been touched after confirmation, including the current candle range; the old plan must not be reused.
- The retest is invalid or expired, the current candle range is unavailable, or the latest price is more than 0.5 ATR from the confirmation close.
- The structure stop exceeds 5% of entry, estimated net reward/risk is below 1.5R, or a prior confirmed swing obstructs the 2R target.

Worked example - illustrative only
Long reference entry 100, stop 99: R = 1, Target 1 = 101, Target 2 = 102.
At 0.07% per fill, the modeled 2R win is 1.8586 and modeled loss is 1.1393 per unit. Net reward/risk is approximately **1.63R**, not 2R after costs.

Rules for the user

Check the exchange, contract, source age, spread and actual fees before using a plan. Define your own position size and maximum loss. The app does not model your leverage, liquidation price, actual funding payments or stop-fill guarantees. An expired plan requires fresh analysis, not a screenshot of an earlier signal.

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Warnings: what to do next

Read the specific pending feed and its timestamp. A page can contain useful results while the latest refresh is only partially complete.

Message	Meaning and next action
Loading	The explicit refresh is still running. Allow paced batches to finish; use Stop refresh if that control is available. Repeated clicks do not bypass exchange limits.
Refresh partially completed	Some requested feeds succeeded and others did not. Read the named failures. The fraction counts feeds, not accuracy or trade confidence.
Baseline warming	A comparable ~1h global-dominance baseline is absent. Current dominance may be visible while full screener setups remain on Watch. Check collector/provider readiness.
Collecting history	A valid historical comparison is missing. For 15m direction, matching prices must be 13.5-16.5 minutes apart. Keep local collection running; later click Refresh. Provider delays can extend the wait.
WAIT	For valid current data, the required conditions do not agree. Inspect the reasons; do not interpret WAIT as LONG or SHORT.
Data unavailable / expired	The source is missing, invalid or too old. Refresh after the source or connection recovers. An old cached observation is not a new signal.
Timestamp mismatch	Provider pages or observations cannot be aligned safely. The app can retain the last valid snapshot with its original age. Check source details and retry after the provider publishes fresh data.
OI recovering / partial	Review matched contracts, USD coverage and per-contract reasons. Local recovery runs in the collector; hosted recovery advances in a user-started refresh. Missing contracts are not assigned zero OI.
Rate limit / cooldown	The provider has limited requests. Let the indicated cooldown expire, then retry. Public availability cannot be guaranteed by more frequent refreshing.

The screenshot case: 4h SHORT + 1h SHORT + 15m COLLECTING does not yet produce a combined SHORT BIAS. The missing item is price/basket history. Complete 4h OI history cannot replace it.

If collecting repeats despite continuous local operation, inspect This PC: service status, latest successful collection, connection errors and source timestamps. Report those details and the affected workspace. Do not clear the history database to resolve a missing baseline.

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Run locally and protect your data

The desktop shortcut starts your local service if needed. Windows startup means sign-in startup; it is not cloud collection.

Situation	Expected behavior
Browser closed	The Windows collector can keep running. Reopening shows saved observations; click Refresh to display newer results.
PC asleep or off	No local collection runs. On resume, available official history may repair some gaps; unobserved intraday prices are not fabricated.
Hosted website	Separate service and storage. It does not inherit the desktop's database or API key. The current hosted OI recovery is initiated by Refresh and saved on the server; it is not a new always-on cloud collector.
New installation	Starts with its own watchlist and history. Verify the installed version; the v0.3.0 installer does not include every newer source change.

Back up before updates or troubleshooting

- Open **This PC** at http://127.0.0.1:8787/local and download a local backup. Check its date before relying on it.
- Preserve **data/state**, watchlists, saved analyses and original research. Use the app's disposable-cache maintenance controls instead of deleting the data folder.
- The installer keeps data under **%LOCALAPPDATA%\Market Lens Local\data**. A source installation normally keeps a data folder alongside the app. Use the location reported by your installation.
- Routine maintenance rotates logs, retains up to 14 daily backups and cleans eligible expired caches. The cache budget does not authorize deleting important saved data.

Optional keys and provider differences

Configure optional provider keys only in local settings. Windows CurrentUser DPAPI protects stored keys; the app excludes them from JSON/database backups. Re-enter a key through settings on another PC. Do not include keys in screenshots, GitHub issues or shared analysis files.

No trading account is connected. The app reads market data; it does not place orders. Local listeners use 127.0.0.1. Your watchlist and private local credentials are not published with the source or copied into the hosted website.

Liquidation heatmaps, news and token unlocks are not connected confirmation feeds. Optional Gate context is separately labeled and does not replace the Binance/OKX checks. Basket proxies and a small spot-flow sample must not be presented as licensed indices or whole-market order flow.

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Your review checklist

This page is fillable. Tick the boxes and save a copy in a PDF reader that supports forms. The checklist records your review; it does not authorize or execute a trade.

Date / time

Coin / contract

Exchange / timeframe

- [ ] I checked the source, timestamp and whether the refresh is complete.
- [ ] I distinguished missing history from a valid WAIT reading.
- [ ] I reviewed 1h + 15m direction, and 4h if alignment is required.
- [ ] I read the selected coin's failed checks and missing inputs.
- [ ] I checked that the plan is current and has not been retired.
- [ ] I reviewed entry, stop, targets, spread, fees and funding.
- [ ] I chose my position size and considered news / event risks.
- [ ] I understand that rule agreement is not a tested win probability.

Decision / reasons / unresolved data

Current project links

Live dashboard: Open Market Lens
Source and updates: Bikash543 / market-lens-local
Windows releases: View release assets and version notes

How these rules were checked

This edition documents the implementation as of 21 October 2026. Primary references in GitHub source commit e149eb6: **lib/engine.ts** (six checks), **lib/compass.ts** (direction), **lib/confirmation.ts** (seven checks and plans), **lib/oi-universe.ts** and **docs/aggregate-oi-history.md** (OI scope), plus readiness and display helpers.

Thresholds describe the software, not validated investment performance. No win-rate or profit-factor promise is made. Historical research strategies discussed earlier are not implicitly part of this app. If a later release changes a rule, its code and version notes take precedence over this dated guide.

Keep this distinction: Refresh success = data request completed. Rule alignment = conditions agree. Profitability = a separate question requiring appropriate testing and actual trading costs.